IELTS SPEAKING INSTRUCTION

Teacher's Handbook

A Complete Guide to IELTS Speaking Instruction

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20 Modules • Test Architecture • Band Descriptors • Classroom Strategies

MODULE

How to Use This Handbook

This handbook is a comprehensive resource for teachers preparing students for the IELTS Speaking test. It is organized into 20 sequential modules, each addressing a specific area of speaking instruction — from understanding the test architecture to designing full lesson plans.

Handbook Structure

Modules	Focus Area
1–3	Test architecture, band descriptors, and diagnostic skills
4–6	Idea generation, input strategies, and response frameworks
7–9	Teaching each part of the IELTS Speaking test
10–13	The four scoring criteria: fluency, vocabulary, grammar, pronunciation
14–15	Error correction and lesson design
16–18	Managing difficult questions and classroom activities
19–20	Mock tests, feedback, and self-assessment

The IDEA Framework

Throughout this handbook, speaking instruction is organized using the IDEA framework:

Stage	Purpose
I — Input	Activate background knowledge and vocabulary
D — Develop Ideas	Generate and organize arguments and examples
E — Express	Deliver the speaking response
A — Advance	Extend and deepen the response

Each module includes: core knowledge, teaching methodology, classroom activities, common teacher mistakes, teaching tips, reflection questions, and a knowledge check.

MODULE 1

The Architecture of the IELTS Speaking Test

Module Overview

The IELTS Speaking test is not simply a conversation. It is a structured interview designed to measure specific communicative abilities across three progressively demanding sections. Understanding the architecture of the test allows teachers to prepare students strategically, simulate realistic speaking tests, and give accurate feedback.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

1. Explain the structure and timing of the IELTS Speaking test.
2. Identify the purpose of each part of the test.
3. Understand how examiners conduct the interview.
4. Recognize how the test progressively increases in difficulty.
5. Simulate the speaking test accurately in the classroom.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Overview of the IELTS Speaking Test

The IELTS Speaking test is a face-to-face interview between the candidate and an examiner. The total duration is approximately 11–14 minutes, and the interview consists of three parts, each designed to assess different speaking abilities.

Part	Time	Focus
Part 1	4–5 minutes	Personal questions
Part 2	3–4 minutes	Individual long turn
Part 3	4–5 minutes	Abstract discussion

The examiner follows a standardized script to ensure fairness and consistency across candidates.

Part 1 — Introduction and Personal Questions

Duration: 4–5 minutes. The examiner asks questions about familiar topics such as hometown, work or studies, hobbies, daily routines, food, and travel. These questions are designed to help candidates relax, assess basic conversational ability, and evaluate fluency in familiar contexts. Candidates should give natural answers of one or two sentences.

Part 2 — The Long Turn

Duration: 3–4 minutes. Candidates receive a cue card with a topic and are given 1 minute to prepare and 1–2 minutes to speak. This section measures fluency, narrative ability, and the ability to organize ideas.

Example cue card:

> *Describe a memorable trip you took.*
> *You should say: where you went • who you went with • what you did there • why it was memorable.*

Part 3 — Two-Way Discussion

Duration: 4–5 minutes. This section expands on the topic introduced in Part 2. Questions become more abstract and analytical. Part 3 measures the candidate's ability to express opinions, justify arguments, compare ideas, and speculate about the future. This section often determines whether a student can reach a higher band.

Progressive Difficulty

Section	Cognitive Demand
Part 1	Personal information
Part 2	Personal storytelling
Part 3	Abstract discussion

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Introducing the IDEA Framework

In this training program, speaking lessons follow the IDEA framework: Input → Develop Ideas → Express → Advance. This ensures students can generate ideas, structure their responses, speak fluently, and extend their answers.

IDEA Stage	Part 1	Part 2	Part 3
Input	Topic introduction	Cue card prompts	Question topic
Develop	Brainstorm personal examples	Plan story	Analyze issue
Express	Short answers	Speak for 2 minutes	Give opinion
Advance	Add one supporting detail	Add reflection	Add explanation and example

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity: Understanding the Test Structure

Analyze the sample speaking questions below and classify them by test part. This helps teachers understand the functional differences between sections.

Question	Part
Do you enjoy traveling?	Part 1
Describe a trip you enjoyed.	Part 2
How has tourism changed in recent years?	Part 3

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Treating all speaking questions the same way.
- Ignoring the planning stage in Part 2.
- Asking Part 3 questions too early in training.
- Overcorrecting grammar during fluency practice.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage students to give complete answers, not single words.
- Train students to speak continuously during Part 2.
- Prepare students for abstract thinking in Part 3.
- Practice timed responses regularly.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why does the IELTS Speaking test use three different sections?
- Which section do students usually find most difficult?
- How can teachers simulate the real speaking test in class?
- How should teaching strategies differ between Parts 1, 2, and 3?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- How long does the IELTS Speaking test usually last?
- Which part of the test requires preparation time?
- Which section requires abstract discussion?
- What four criteria are used to score speaking performance?

MODULE 2

Understanding the IELTS Speaking Band Descriptors

Module Overview

The IELTS Speaking test is evaluated using four assessment criteria, known as the band descriptors. Each criterion is scored individually, and the final speaking band score is the average of the four scores. Understanding these descriptors allows teachers to identify student weaknesses, provide targeted feedback, and train students more effectively.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

6. Identify the four IELTS speaking band criteria.
7. Explain how examiners determine band scores.
8. Recognize the characteristics of different band levels.
9. Diagnose student performance using the descriptors.
10. Provide feedback aligned with IELTS scoring standards.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

The Four Assessment Criteria

Criterion	Focus
Fluency and Coherence	Flow and organization of speech
Lexical Resource	Range and accuracy of vocabulary
Grammatical Range and Accuracy	Variety and correctness of grammar
Pronunciation	Clarity and intelligibility of speech

Criterion 1 — Fluency and Coherence

Fluency refers to how smoothly and naturally a candidate speaks. Coherence refers to how logically ideas are organized and connected. Common indicators of weak fluency include frequent pauses, repetition, hesitation, and self-correction. These speech patterns are specifically mentioned in IELTS scoring guidelines as indicators of lower fluency levels.

Criterion 2 — Lexical Resource

Lexical Resource evaluates whether a candidate can use appropriate vocabulary, paraphrase effectively, and avoid excessive repetition. Higher band scores require flexible vocabulary use, natural collocations, and the ability to express nuanced ideas.

Criterion 3 — Grammatical Range and Accuracy

This criterion evaluates both the variety of grammar structures and the accuracy of grammar usage. High-level candidates demonstrate complex sentences, conditionals, relative clauses, and varied sentence structures. Importantly, minor grammar mistakes do not automatically reduce the score if communication remains clear.

Criterion 4 — Pronunciation

Pronunciation is assessed based on intelligibility — the ability to communicate clearly. Candidates are not expected to sound like native speakers. Accents are acceptable; clarity is more important than perfection. Examiners evaluate word stress, sentence stress, rhythm, intonation, and linking sounds.

How the Final Speaking Score Is Calculated

Each criterion is scored individually. The four scores are averaged and rounded to the nearest half band.

Criterion	Example Score
Fluency and Coherence	6
Lexical Resource	7
Grammatical Range and Accuracy	6
Pronunciation	6

Average: (6 + 7 + 6 + 6) ÷ 4 = 6.25 → rounded to Band 6.5. Note: In some institutional contexts, scores may be rounded down to the nearest half band (Band 6.0).

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Using the IDEA Framework with Band Criteria

IDEA Stage	Band Criteria Developed
Input	Vocabulary and topic understanding
Develop Ideas	Coherence and logical organization
Express	Fluency and grammar
Advance	Vocabulary sophistication and reasoning

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Identifying Band Evidence

Analyze a sample student response and identify evidence for each band criterion.

Sample response (italics):

> *"I think traveling is important because it allows people to learn about other cultures. For example, when I visited Japan, I experienced many traditions that were very different from my own country."*

Criterion	Evidence in Response
Fluency	Continuous, uninterrupted speech
Lexical Resource	Words like "traditions" and "culture"
Grammar	Complex sentence structure with "because"
Pronunciation	Intelligible speech (assumed from context)

Activity 2 — Diagnosing Student Weaknesses

Listen to student recordings and determine which band criterion is weakest. For example: if a student pauses frequently but uses good vocabulary, the diagnosis is a fluency problem, not a vocabulary problem. Teachers then design activities targeting fluency development.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Focusing only on grammar accuracy.
- Correcting students too frequently during speaking.
- Ignoring fluency development.
- Overlooking pronunciation training.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage students to expand answers, not just speak correctly.
- Train paraphrasing to improve vocabulary scores.
- Use timed speaking activities to improve fluency.
- Provide pronunciation feedback on stress and rhythm, not just individual sounds.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is grammar only one part of the speaking score?
- Which band criterion do students struggle with most?
- How can teachers design activities that develop multiple criteria at once?
- Why is fluency important even if grammar is imperfect?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What are the four IELTS speaking assessment criteria?
- How is the final speaking band score calculated?
- Which criterion measures vocabulary flexibility?
- Which criterion evaluates clarity of speech?

MODULE 3

Diagnosing Student Speaking Performance

Module Overview

One of the most important skills for IELTS speaking teachers is the ability to diagnose student performance accurately. To improve students' speaking scores, teachers must first identify which aspect of speaking is limiting performance. Effective teachers learn to observe, diagnose, and target weaknesses systematically using a diagnostic cycle: Observe → Diagnose → Train → Reassess.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

11. Identify the most common speaking problems IELTS students experience.
12. Diagnose performance issues using the band descriptors.
13. Distinguish between fluency problems and language problems.
14. Analyze student responses for evidence of strengths and weaknesses.
15. Provide targeted feedback based on diagnostic evidence.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

The Four Types of Speaking Problems

Problem Type	Description	Related Criterion
Fluency Problems	Hesitation, pauses, repetition	Fluency and Coherence
Vocabulary Problems	Limited lexical range	Lexical Resource
Grammar Problems	Incorrect sentence structures	Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Pronunciation Problems	Difficulty being understood	Pronunciation

Fluency Problems

Common indicators: long pauses, filler words ("uh", "um"), repetition, false starts, and self-corrections. Students with fluency problems may know the answer but cannot express ideas smoothly.

Vocabulary Problems

Common signs: repeating the same words frequently, using very basic vocabulary, and difficulty paraphrasing. Example of a vocabulary-limited response: "I like traveling because it is very good and very nice." The student has the idea but lacks the vocabulary to express it effectively.

Grammar Problems

Typical indicators: incorrect verb tenses, missing articles, incorrect word order, and overuse of simple sentences. Teachers should identify whether the issue is accuracy (errors) or range (limited sentence structures). Example: "Yesterday I go to the market and buy many thing."

Pronunciation Problems

Common issues: incorrect word stress, unclear consonant sounds, monotone intonation, and syllable omission. Remember: accent is not a problem as long as speech remains intelligible. Examiners evaluate pronunciation based on clarity and ease of understanding.

Diagnostic Questions Teachers Should Ask

Question	Criterion Addressed
Did the student have ideas?	Fluency and Coherence
Could the student organize those ideas?	Fluency and Coherence
Could the student express those ideas clearly?	Lexical Resource / Grammar
Was the speech easy to understand?	Pronunciation

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Separating Thinking Problems from Language Problems

Problem Type	Example	Intervention
Thinking Problem	Student does not know what to say	Provide input and brainstorming activities
Language Problem	Student has an idea but cannot express it	Focus on vocabulary and grammar development

Using the IDEA Framework for Diagnosis

Stage	Possible Student Problem
Input	Student lacks background knowledge
Develop Ideas	Student cannot generate arguments
Express	Student struggles with vocabulary or grammar
Advance	Student cannot extend answers

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Diagnostic Listening

Listen to a recorded student response and identify the main problem. Example: Student pauses frequently but uses good vocabulary → Diagnosis: Fluency problem → Recommended training: Timed speaking practice.

Activity 2 — Transcript Analysis

Analyze a student transcript and mark examples of hesitation, repetition, grammar errors, and vocabulary limitations.

Activity 3 — Problem Identification

Classify student responses into categories. Example: "I like technology because it is good for people and good for communication." → Diagnosis: Vocabulary limitation → Recommended training: Collocation practice.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Focusing only on grammar mistakes.
- Interrupting students too often.
- Giving feedback without clear evidence.
- Ignoring fluency development.

TEACHING TIPS

- Allow students to finish speaking before correcting errors.
- Focus on one improvement area at a time.
- Provide feedback using the band descriptors.
- Encourage students to reflect on their speaking performance.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is diagnosis important before giving feedback?
- How can teachers identify whether a problem is linguistic or conceptual?
- Which type of speaking problem do your students experience most often?
- How can diagnostic analysis improve speaking instruction?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What are the four major types of speaking problems?
- Why should teachers diagnose problems before correcting errors?
- What is the difference between a thinking problem and a language problem?
- Which IELTS criterion relates to hesitation and pauses?

MODULE 4

The Idea Generation Problem in IELTS Speaking

Module Overview

One of the most common challenges in IELTS speaking classes is that students struggle to generate ideas when answering questions. Many students pause or give extremely short answers because they do not know what to say, rather than because they lack English ability. Teachers must therefore train students not only to speak English, but also to develop and organize ideas quickly.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

16. Identify why students struggle to generate ideas during speaking tasks.
17. Distinguish between idea-generation problems and language problems.
18. Use teaching strategies that help students develop ideas before speaking.
19. Introduce structured thinking frameworks that support speaking responses.
20. Reduce student anxiety during speaking activities.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Why Students Struggle to Generate Ideas

Problem	Description	Implication for Teaching
Conceptual Gap	Student does not understand what the question requires	Teach question interpretation skills
Knowledge Gap	Student lacks background knowledge on the topic	Provide content input before speaking
Language Gap	Student has ideas but cannot express them	Focus on vocabulary and grammar development

Teachers frequently assume the problem is language, when the real problem is ideas. For example, when asked "Do you think technology has improved communication?", some students respond: "I don't know... maybe yes... because technology is good." This happens not from lack of grammar, but from not knowing what aspects to discuss or what examples to give.

Why Traditional Speaking Classes Fail

Many speaking lessons follow this pattern: Question → Student Answer → Correction. This assumes students already have ideas ready to express. However, many learners require idea activation before speaking. Without idea support, students may freeze, give very short answers, or rely on memorized responses.

The Input → Processing → Output Model

Stage	What Happens	Example Activity
Input	Students receive information related to the topic	Short reading, statistics, images, or opinion statements
Processing	Students analyze the information and generate ideas	Brainstorming, comparing viewpoints, identifying causes and effects
Output	Students answer IELTS-style questions using generated ideas	Speaking practice with topic-specific vocabulary already activated

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Introducing the IDEA Speaking Framework

Stage	Description	Classroom Application
I — Input	Teacher provides information related to the speaking topic	"Tourism can help a country's economy, but it can also create environmental problems."
D — Develop Ideas	Students generate viewpoints using structured thinking patterns	List advantages vs. disadvantages, causes vs. effects, comparisons
E — Express	Students answer the speaking question using generated ideas	IELTS-style question answered with confidence and content
A — Advance	Students extend answers with examples and future developments	Add predictions, deeper reasoning, cross-topic comparisons

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Input Discussion

Teacher presents a statement (e.g., "Many people believe online learning will replace traditional classrooms") and students discuss advantages and disadvantages. After brainstorming, students answer the IELTS question: "Do you think online education is effective?"

Activity 2 — Idea Mapping

Students create a quick idea map before speaking. For a topic like "Public transportation," they list benefits, problems, and examples before answering a speaking question.

Activity 3 — Opinion Expansion

Students use the structure: Opinion → Reason → Example. Example: "I believe public transportation is important because it reduces traffic congestion. For example, in my city the subway system allows thousands of people to commute efficiently."

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Asking difficult speaking questions without any preparation.
- Expecting students to respond immediately.
- Focusing only on language errors rather than idea development.
- Skipping idea-development activities entirely.

TEACHING TIPS

- Provide topic input before asking complex questions.
- Encourage students to brainstorm ideas in pairs.
- Teach simple thinking frameworks such as advantages/disadvantages.
- Focus on idea development before correcting language errors.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why do students often struggle with idea generation in speaking tasks?
- How can teachers distinguish between idea problems and language problems?
- How does input support speaking development?
- How can teachers encourage students to expand their answers?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What are the three common causes of idea-generation problems?
- What are the three stages of the Input → Processing → Output model?
- What does the IDEA framework stand for?
- Why is idea generation important for IELTS speaking performance?

MODULE 5

Using Input to Support Speaking Development

Module Overview

Many IELTS speaking classes focus almost entirely on output activities. While practice is important, excessive output without sufficient input can lead to limited idea generation, repetitive answers, student frustration, and speaking fatigue. Input activates background knowledge, vocabulary, and conceptual understanding of the topic, allowing students to respond more confidently and produce more detailed and coherent answers.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

21. Explain why input is important in speaking classes.
22. Identify different types of input materials.
23. Use input to activate vocabulary and ideas.
24. Transition smoothly from input activities to speaking practice.
25. Balance input and output in IELTS speaking lessons.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Types of Input Materials

Input Type	Example	Best Used For
Short Readings	A paragraph about renewable energy	Vocabulary activation and context building
Statistics	Data about social media usage	Providing discussion points and evidence
Images	Photos related to urban life	Visual prompts for descriptive speaking
Opinion Statements	"Online learning is better than traditional classrooms."	Debate and position practice
Videos	Short clips introducing a topic	Listening activation and engagement

Balancing Input and Output

Stage	Recommended Time Allocation
Input	30%
Idea Development	30%
Speaking Practice	40%

Speaking remains the largest component, but input supports idea generation. Teachers must avoid turning speaking lessons into reading lessons.

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Applying the IDEA Framework

Stage	Activity
Input	Teacher introduces topic using a short reading, statistic, image, or opinion statement
Develop Ideas	Students discuss input in pairs or small groups, identifying advantages/disadvantages, causes/effects, or future predictions
Express	Students answer IELTS-style speaking questions, drawing on the ideas generated
Advance	Teacher asks follow-up questions to encourage deeper discussion

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Image-Based Input

Show a photograph (e.g., a crowded city street). Students discuss: "What problems do you see?" and "How could this be solved?" before answering: "Do you think cities should limit the number of cars?"

Activity 2 — Opinion Statement

Present a statement (e.g., "Social media has improved communication"). Students choose a position and give reasons and examples before answering an IELTS question.

Activity 3 — Vocabulary Activation

Before speaking, students brainstorm vocabulary for a topic (e.g., Travel: transportation, accommodation, tourist attractions). Then they answer: "Why do people like traveling?"

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Providing too much input, making lessons feel like reading classes.
- Allowing input activities to run too long.
- Skipping the speaking stage entirely.
- Focusing only on vocabulary lists instead of connected speaking.

TEACHING TIPS

- Use short input materials (1–3 minutes maximum).
- Choose input directly related to speaking topics.
- Encourage students to react to the input before speaking.
- Transition quickly from input to speaking tasks.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is input important in speaking lessons?
- How can teachers prevent input activities from becoming too long?
- Which types of input materials work best for speaking classes?
- How can input help students generate ideas?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What are three examples of input materials teachers can use?
- Why is input important before speaking tasks?
- What is the recommended balance between input and output?
- Which stage of the IDEA framework does input correspond to?

MODULE 6

Idea Development Frameworks for IELTS Speaking

Module Overview

Many IELTS candidates struggle not because they lack ideas, but because they do not know how to structure their responses. Idea development frameworks help students organize their thoughts quickly, extend their answers, provide examples, and maintain logical flow. Developing structured answers directly improves the Fluency and Coherence criterion.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

26. Explain why structured thinking improves speaking performance.
27. Teach students simple frameworks for developing answers.
28. Use frameworks appropriate for different IELTS speaking tasks.
29. Help students expand short answers into longer responses.
30. Encourage students to give clearer explanations and examples.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Types of IELTS Speaking Questions

Question Type	Example	Recommended Framework
Opinion	Do you think public transportation should be free?	ORE (Opinion → Reason → Example)
Experience	Describe a memorable trip.	Storytelling (Situation → Events → Feelings → Reflection)
Comparison	How is life different now compared to the past?	Past / Present / Future
Prediction	How might technology change education in the future?	Past / Present / Future
Cause/Effect	Why do many people move to big cities?	Cause and Effect

Key Idea Development Frameworks

Framework 1 — ORE (Opinion → Reason → Example)

Most useful for Part 1 and Part 3 questions.

Example question: "Do you think exercise is important?"

> *"Yes, I believe exercise is very important because it helps people maintain good physical and mental health. For example, regular exercise can reduce stress and improve overall fitness."*

Framework 2 — Advantages and Disadvantages

Best for Part 3 discussion questions.

> *"One advantage of online education is flexibility because students can study from anywhere. However, a disadvantage is that some students may feel isolated without face-to-face interaction."*

Framework 3 — Cause and Effect

Useful for analytical questions in Part 3.

> *"Many people move to big cities because they offer better job opportunities. As a result, cities often experience rapid population growth."*

Framework 4 — Past / Present / Future

Works well for comparison and prediction questions.

> *"In the past, most people traveled by train or bus. Today, many people prefer private cars or airplanes. In the future, we may see more electric and autonomous vehicles."*

Framework 5 — Storytelling (Part 2)

Stage	Content	Example (Memorable Trip)
Situation	Where and when the experience took place	Last summer, I traveled to Jeju Island with my family.
Events	What happened during the experience	We explored beaches and visited famous landmarks.
Feelings	How you felt and why	I felt very relaxed because the scenery was beautiful.
Reflection	What you learned or why it was memorable	This trip allowed me to spend quality time with my family.

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Teaching Frameworks as Thinking Tools

Teachers should avoid making students memorize rigid formulas. Instead, frameworks should be presented as thinking tools that students adapt naturally during speaking. Frameworks help students organize ideas quickly, especially under time pressure.

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Expanding Short Answers

Question: "Do you like traveling?" Student gives a short answer: "Yes, I like traveling." Teacher guides expansion using ORE: Opinion → Reason → Example.

Activity 2 — Framework Matching

Question	Best Framework
Do you think children should use smartphones?	Opinion → Reason → Example
What are the advantages of living in a big city?	Advantages / Disadvantages
How has technology changed communication?	Past / Present / Future

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Expecting students to give long answers without structural guidance.
- Correcting grammar before ideas are developed.
- Introducing too many frameworks at once.
- Forcing students to memorize rigid structures.

TEACHING TIPS

- Introduce frameworks gradually, one at a time.
- Practice frameworks using simple questions first.
- Encourage students to add examples whenever possible.
- Focus on clarity of ideas before correcting grammar.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why do students struggle to organize ideas when speaking?
- How do frameworks reduce cognitive load?
- Which frameworks are most useful for Part 3 questions?
- How can teachers prevent frameworks from sounding unnatural?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What is the purpose of idea development frameworks?
- What does the ORE framework stand for?
- Which framework is useful for comparison questions?
- Which type of speaking task requires the storytelling structure?

MODULE 7

Teaching IELTS Speaking Part 1

Module Overview

Part 1 is the introduction and interview section of the IELTS Speaking test. The examiner asks questions about familiar personal topics. The purpose is to help candidates feel comfortable, evaluate basic conversational ability, and assess fluency in familiar contexts. For teachers, Part 1 is an opportunity to train students to answer naturally, expand short answers, and maintain conversational flow.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

31. Explain the purpose of Part 1 of the IELTS Speaking test.
32. Train students to give natural and extended answers.
33. Help students avoid memorized responses.
34. Teach techniques for expanding short answers.
35. Build student confidence in conversational speaking.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Typical Part 1 Topics and Questions

Topic	Example Question
Hometown	What do you like about your hometown?
Work or Study	What subject do you study?
Hobbies	What do you like to do in your free time?
Food	What kind of food do you enjoy?
Travel	Do you enjoy traveling?

Expected Answer Length and Structure

Part 1 answers should usually be two to three sentences. Very short answers may indicate weak fluency.

Answer Type	Example
Weak (too short)	"Yes, I like traveling."
Stronger (expanded)	"Yes, I really enjoy traveling because it allows me to experience different cultures. For example, when I visited Japan, I was fascinated by the food and traditional architecture."

Expanding answers demonstrates fluency and lexical resource — both key scoring criteria.

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

The Answer Expansion Pattern

Train students to follow this simple structure: Answer → Reason → Example / Detail. For the question "Do you enjoy reading?": "Yes, I enjoy reading because it helps me relax after a long day. For instance, I often read novels before going to bed."

Encouraging Natural Conversation

Remind students that Part 1 is not a speech. Students should speak naturally, respond quickly, and avoid memorized answers. Memorized responses often sound unnatural and may reduce the candidate's score.

IDEA Framework in Part 1

Stage	Application in Part 1
Input	The question topic itself
Develop	Think of a personal example or experience
Express	Give the answer naturally
Advance	Add one supporting detail or reason

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Expanding Short Answers

Teacher asks a simple question (e.g., "Do you like cooking?"). Student gives a short response. Teacher asks follow-up prompts: "Why?", "What kind of food?", "When do you cook?" Student expands their answer with each prompt.

Activity 2 — Rapid Question Practice

Teacher asks a series of quick questions (e.g., "Do you prefer coffee or tea?", "What do you do on weekends?"). Students must respond immediately. This improves fluency and spontaneous speaking.

Activity 3 — Topic Rotation

Students practice answering questions from different Part 1 topics (hobbies, hometown, travel, food) and give two- or three-sentence answers for each.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Spending too much time on Part 1 practice at the expense of Parts 2 and 3.
- Allowing students to memorize scripted answers.
- Asking overly complex questions during Part 1 practice.
- Correcting grammar excessively during fluency-focused practice.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage students to speak naturally and confidently.
- Teach students to add one supporting detail to every answer.
- Practice quick responses to reduce hesitation.
- Focus on fluency rather than perfect grammar during this section.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why are Part 1 topics usually personal and familiar?
- How can teachers encourage students to expand short answers?
- Why should students avoid memorized responses?
- How can teachers help students respond more quickly?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- How long does Part 1 usually last?
- What types of topics appear in Part 1?
- How many sentences should a typical Part 1 answer include?
- What simple structure can students use to expand answers?

MODULE 8

Teaching IELTS Speaking Part 2 — The Long Turn

Module Overview

Part 2 requires candidates to speak independently for an extended period. Candidates receive a cue card, have 1 minute to prepare, and then speak for 1–2 minutes. This section measures the ability to organize ideas, speak fluently for an extended time, and provide details and examples. Sustained speech helps examiners evaluate fluency and coherence.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

36. Explain the structure and timing of Part 2.
37. Train students to use the 1-minute preparation time effectively.
38. Teach storytelling techniques that support longer responses.
39. Help students organize ideas during the long turn.
40. Prevent students from running out of ideas during their speech.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Structure of Part 2

Stage	Time	What Happens
Preparation	1 minute	Candidate reads cue card, takes notes, plans structure
Speaking	1–2 minutes	Candidate delivers extended response; examiner does not interrupt

Types of Part 2 Topics

Topic Type	Example Cue Card
Experience	Describe a memorable trip you took.
Person	Describe someone who inspired you.
Place	Describe a place you enjoy visiting.
Object	Describe an important item you own.
Event	Describe a celebration you attended.

Storytelling Structure for Part 2

Stage	Guiding Question	Example
Situation	Where and when did this happen?	"Last summer, I traveled to Jeju Island with my family."
Events	What happened? What did you do?	"We explored the beaches and visited several famous landmarks."
Feelings	How did you feel? Why?	"I felt very relaxed because the scenery was beautiful."
Reflection	Why was it memorable? What did you learn?	"This trip allowed me to spend quality time with my family."

Using the 1-Minute Preparation Time

Teachers should train students to follow this process: (1) Identify the topic. (2) Select a specific example. (3) Outline key points. (4) Plan the structure. Example notes for a "memorable trip" topic:

Note Element	Example
Topic / Example	Trip to Japan — with friends
Key Detail 1	Visited Kyoto temples
Key Detail 2	Tried traditional food
Reflection	Memorable because of cultural discovery

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Training the Planning Stage

Students should follow: Topic → Example → Key Details → Ending. Many students waste preparation time because they do not know what to do with it. This process gives them a clear routine to follow under time pressure.

IDEA Framework in Part 2

Stage	Part 2 Application
Input	Cue card provides the topic and prompts
Develop Ideas	Planning notes organize the story
Express	Deliver the 2-minute speech
Advance	Add reflections and personal insights

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — One-Minute Planning Practice

Give students cue cards and one minute to plan (keywords + story outline). After one minute, students deliver a two-minute response. This trains efficient use of preparation time.

Activity 2 — Story Expansion

Students tell a short story in 30 seconds, then expand it to 2 minutes by adding details, descriptions, and personal reflections. This builds speaking stamina.

Activity 3 — Cue Card Rotation

Students rotate through multiple cue cards ("Describe a favorite teacher", "Describe a useful technology", "Describe a place you like to visit"). Students practice planning and speaking repeatedly with different topics.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Skipping the planning preparation stage.
- Forcing students to memorize answers.
- Interrupting students during the long turn.
- Focusing too much on grammar correction rather than fluency.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage students to give personal, specific examples.
- Teach students to add descriptive details.
- Remind students that cue card prompts are guidelines, not strict rules.
- Train students to keep speaking even if they make small mistakes.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is the one-minute preparation stage important?
- How can storytelling structures improve speaking responses?
- What causes students to run out of ideas during Part 2?
- How can teachers train students to speak for two minutes comfortably?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- How much preparation time is given in Part 2?
- How long should students speak during the long turn?
- What types of topics appear in Part 2?
- Why are storytelling structures useful for Part 2 responses?

MODULE 9

Teaching IELTS Speaking Part 3 — Abstract Discussion

Module Overview

Part 3 is the two-way discussion section. It follows the topic introduced in Part 2 but shifts from personal experience to broader social issues and abstract ideas. This section typically lasts 4–5 minutes and often determines whether a candidate can achieve a higher band. It requires deeper reasoning and more advanced language.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

41. Explain the purpose of Part 3 of the IELTS Speaking test.
42. Teach students how to respond to abstract questions.
43. Train students to justify opinions with reasons and examples.
44. Develop students' analytical thinking skills.
45. Prepare students for follow-up discussion questions.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Typical Part 3 Questions

Question Type	Example
Opinion	Do you think technology improves education?
Cause	Why do people prefer living in big cities?
Comparison	How is education different today compared to the past?
Prediction	How might transportation change in the future?
Problem–Solution	What can governments do to reduce pollution?

Discourse Patterns for Part 3

Pattern 1 — Opinion → Reason → Example

"Yes, I believe public transportation should be free because it encourages more people to use environmentally friendly transportation. For example, several cities have introduced free public transit to reduce traffic congestion."

Pattern 2 — Cause → Effect

"Many people move to big cities because they offer better employment opportunities. As a result, urban populations continue to grow rapidly."

Pattern 3 — Advantage → Disadvantage

"One advantage of social media is that it allows people to stay connected with friends and family. However, a disadvantage is that excessive use may reduce face-to-face interaction."

Pattern 4 — Past → Present → Future

"In the past, people relied mainly on letters and phone calls. Today, communication is dominated by social media and instant messaging. In the future, communication may become even more advanced with new digital technologies."

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Training Students to Develop Arguments

Students should learn that Part 3 responses require three elements: Opinion → Explanation → Example. Teachers should encourage students to support their ideas with evidence or examples, which improves coherence, vocabulary range, and grammatical complexity.

IDEA Framework in Part 3

Stage	Part 3 Application
Input	Topic introduction from Part 2
Develop Ideas	Analyze the issue; consider multiple perspectives
Express	State opinion clearly
Advance	Provide deeper reasoning, predictions, comparisons

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Opinion Expansion

Teacher asks a Part 3 question (e.g., "Should governments invest more in public transportation?"). Students answer using: Opinion → Reason → Example.

Activity 2 — Debate Practice

Students are divided into two groups. One group argues for a position, the other argues against. Students present arguments and examples. This trains them to justify opinions clearly.

Activity 3 — Follow-Up Question Training

Teacher asks a series of connected questions on the same topic (e.g., "Why do people enjoy traveling?" → "How has tourism changed in recent years?" → "How might tourism develop in the future?"). Students practice building ideas across a full discussion.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Treating Part 3 like Part 1 and asking only simple personal questions.
- Interrupting students too frequently.
- Neglecting idea development activities.
- Not helping students recognize which discourse patterns to use.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage students to provide reasons and examples for every opinion.
- Train students to compare ideas and perspectives.
- Introduce vocabulary related to social issues.
- Allow students time to think before answering complex questions.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is Part 3 more difficult than the other speaking sections?
- How can teachers help students develop stronger arguments?
- Which discourse patterns are most useful for abstract questions?
- How can teachers encourage deeper discussion in speaking classes?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- How long does Part 3 usually last?
- What types of questions appear in Part 3?
- What structure can students use to justify opinions?
- Why is Part 3 important for achieving higher band scores?

MODULE 10

Teaching Fluency Development

Module Overview

Fluency is one of the four criteria used to assess IELTS speaking performance. It refers to the ability to speak smoothly, continuously, and with minimal hesitation. In IELTS speaking assessment, fluency means the natural flow of speech — not speaking quickly. Fluency is closely connected to coherence, and together they form the Fluency and Coherence criterion.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

46. Explain what fluency means in the IELTS Speaking test.
47. Identify common causes of hesitation in student speech.
48. Use classroom techniques to improve speaking flow.
49. Design fluency-focused speaking activities.
50. Help students maintain speech during extended answers.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Common Causes of Fluency Problems

Cause	Description	Teaching Response
Idea Generation	Student does not know what to say	Use input and idea-development activities first
Vocabulary Retrieval	Student cannot find the right word	Teach paraphrasing and synonyms
Grammar Monitoring	Student tries to speak perfectly	Encourage communication over perfection
Anxiety	Student feels nervous during speaking	Create a supportive, low-stakes practice environment

Fluency Practice vs Accuracy Practice

Practice Type	Focus	Correction Timing
Fluency Practice	Continuous speaking; communication over perfection	After the activity
Accuracy Practice	Grammar and vocabulary correctness	During or immediately after

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Timed Speaking

Students answer a question for a fixed amount of time (30 seconds, then 60 seconds). The goal is to maintain continuous speech. Example: "What do you usually do on weekends?"

Activity 2 — The 4–3–2 Fluency Technique

Students repeat the same answer three times with decreasing time limits (4 minutes → 3 minutes → 2 minutes). Each repetition becomes smoother and more fluent, helping students reduce hesitation and organize ideas more efficiently.

Activity 3 — Speaking Loops

Students answer several related questions in sequence without long pauses. Example (Topic: Travel): "Do you like traveling?" → "Where do you usually travel?" → "What do you enjoy most about traveling?"

Activity 4 — Paraphrasing Practice

Students practice expressing the same idea using different words. Example: "Traveling helps people learn about other cultures" → "Traveling allows individuals to understand different cultures." This improves both fluency and lexical flexibility.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Interrupting students too frequently during speaking.
- Correcting grammar during fluency-focused practice.
- Expecting perfect accuracy from fluency tasks.
- Limiting student speaking time unnecessarily.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage students to keep speaking even if they make mistakes.
- Use timed speaking exercises regularly.
- Allow students to practice answers multiple times.
- Focus on communication rather than perfection during fluency tasks.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is fluency important in IELTS speaking performance?
- What causes students to hesitate when speaking?
- How can teachers balance fluency and accuracy practice?
- Which classroom activities help improve speaking flow?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What does fluency mean in IELTS speaking assessment?
- What are common causes of hesitation in speech?
- What is the purpose of the 4–3–2 fluency technique?
- Why should teachers avoid interrupting students during fluency practice?

MODULE 11

Teaching Vocabulary Development

Module Overview

Lexical Resource is one of the four IELTS speaking assessment criteria. It refers to a candidate's ability to use a wide range of vocabulary, express ideas precisely, paraphrase when necessary, and use natural word combinations. Students with limited vocabulary often repeat words, struggle to express complex ideas, and pause frequently while searching for words.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

51. Explain how lexical resource is assessed in IELTS Speaking.
52. Identify common vocabulary limitations in student speech.
53. Teach students how to paraphrase effectively.
54. Introduce collocations and natural word combinations.
55. Design classroom activities that expand speaking vocabulary.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Signs of Limited Vocabulary

Problem	Example	Improvement Strategy
Repetition	"I like traveling because it is very good."	Teach synonyms and paraphrase alternatives
Vague language	"This thing is very interesting."	Teach precise descriptive vocabulary
Limited description	"The place was nice."	Teach collocations and topic vocabulary
Word search pauses	Long hesitation while finding words	Teach paraphrasing as a communication strategy

Vocabulary Range and Band Scores

Band Level	Vocabulary Characteristics
Band 6	Repeats common words; uses basic vocabulary accurately; limited paraphrasing
Band 7+	Uses less common vocabulary; paraphrases effectively; describes ideas with greater precision

Teaching Paraphrasing Skills

Paraphrasing allows students to express the same idea using different words.

Original Word	Paraphrased Alternatives
important	significant, essential, meaningful, crucial
good	beneficial, effective, valuable, positive
change	transform, evolve, shift, alter
show	demonstrate, illustrate, reveal, highlight

Teaching Collocations

Collocations are words that naturally appear together. Teaching them helps students sound more natural and fluent.

Verb	Natural Collocation	Incorrect Form
make	make a decision	"do a decision"
make	make progress	"do progress"
take	take responsibility	"do responsibility"
play	play an important role	"do an important role"
have	have an opportunity	"get an opportunity"

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Vocabulary Expansion

Teacher presents a basic word (e.g., "good"). Students brainstorm alternatives: beneficial, useful, positive, effective. Students practice using these in sentences.

Activity 2 — Collocation Matching

Students match verbs with nouns (make + progress, take + responsibility, have + an opportunity). Then they create speaking responses using the collocations.

Activity 3 — Paraphrasing Practice

Teacher gives a sentence. Students paraphrase it. Example: "Social media is important for communication." → "Social media plays a crucial role in modern communication."

Activity 4 — Topic Vocabulary Discussion

Students receive a speaking question, brainstorm topic vocabulary first, then answer. Example (Travel): brainstorm "cultural experience, relaxation, adventure, exploration" before answering "Why do people enjoy traveling?"

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Focusing on memorizing long vocabulary lists without context.
- Emphasizing rare or difficult words instead of useful everyday vocabulary.
- Teaching vocabulary without connecting it to real speaking tasks.
- Neglecting speaking practice after vocabulary instruction.

TEACHING TIPS

- Teach vocabulary within speaking topics, not in isolation.
- Encourage students to paraphrase repeated words.
- Introduce useful collocations rather than rare vocabulary.
- Provide opportunities for students to use new vocabulary immediately.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- What does lexical resource mean in IELTS speaking assessment?
- Why is paraphrasing an important skill for speaking?
- How can teachers introduce vocabulary effectively in speaking lessons?
- Why are collocations important for natural speech?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What is lexical resource?
- What are two signs of limited vocabulary in speaking?
- What is a collocation?
- Why is paraphrasing useful for IELTS speaking?

MODULE 12

Teaching Grammatical Range and Accuracy

Module Overview

Grammatical Range and Accuracy is one of the four IELTS speaking assessment criteria. It measures a candidate's ability to use a variety of grammatical structures and produce sentences with reasonable accuracy. Students with stronger grammatical control can express more complex ideas and produce longer, more sophisticated responses.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

56. Explain how grammar is assessed in the IELTS Speaking test.
57. Identify common grammatical weaknesses in student speech.
58. Teach students to use a wider range of sentence structures.
59. Integrate grammar development into speaking activities.
60. Provide effective corrective feedback during speaking lessons.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Grammatical Range vs Accuracy

Concept	Definition	Example
Grammatical Range	Variety of sentence structures used	Using conditionals, relative clauses, and complex sentences, not just simple sentences
Grammatical Accuracy	Correctness of grammatical structures	"She goes to school every day" (correct) vs "She go to school every day" (incorrect)

Sentence Complexity Development

Level	Example Sentence
Basic (limited range)	"I like traveling. It is fun. I go with friends."
Intermediate	"I enjoy traveling because it is fun, and I often go with friends."
Advanced (stronger range)	"I enjoy traveling because it allows me to experience different cultures, especially when I travel with close friends."

Common Grammatical Errors in Speaking

Error Type	Incorrect Example	Correct Form
Verb tense	"Yesterday I go to the market."	"Yesterday I went to the market."
Subject–verb agreement	"She go to school every day."	"She goes to school every day."
Article usage	"I visited university."	"I visited a university."
Word form	"He is success in business."	"He is successful in business."

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Encouraging Sentence Expansion

Stage	Example Sentence	Structure Used
Basic	"I like traveling."	Simple sentence
Expanded	"I like traveling because it allows me to learn about different cultures."	Complex sentence with "because"
Advanced	"I like traveling because it allows me to learn about different cultures, which broadens my perspective on the world."	Complex sentence with relative clause

Corrective Feedback Techniques

Technique	How It Works	Example
Recasting	Teacher repeats with correct form	Student: "She go to school." Teacher: "Yes, she goes to school."
Elicitation	Teacher prompts self-correction	Teacher: "She go... or she...?" Student: "She goes."
Metalinguistic Feedback	Teacher names the error type	Teacher: "Past tense?" Student: "He went yesterday."

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Sentence Expansion

Teacher provides a basic sentence (e.g., "I enjoy watching movies"). Students expand it by adding reasons, details, and examples: "I enjoy watching movies because they help me relax after a long day at work."

Activity 2 — Combining Ideas

Students combine two simple sentences into one complex sentence. "Traveling is exciting." + "It helps people learn about other cultures." → "Traveling is exciting because it helps people learn about other cultures."

Activity 3 — Grammar Awareness Review

After a speaking activity, the teacher identifies common errors and examples of strong structures. Students revise their responses. This improves grammar without interrupting fluency practice.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Interrupting students frequently during speaking to correct grammar.
- Focusing excessively on grammar accuracy at the expense of communication.
- Teaching grammar separately from speaking practice.
- Discouraging students from speaking freely due to fear of errors.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage students to combine ideas into longer sentences.
- Highlight useful grammar patterns during speaking activities.
- Focus on common speaking-related grammar errors, not every possible mistake.
- Provide feedback after speaking practice rather than during it.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- What is the difference between grammatical range and grammatical accuracy?
- Why should grammar be taught within speaking activities?
- How can teachers help students produce more complex sentences?
- What feedback techniques are most effective during speaking lessons?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What does grammatical range refer to?
- What are common grammatical errors in speaking?
- Why is sentence expansion useful for grammar development?
- When should teachers provide grammar correction during speaking activities?

MODULE 13

Teaching Pronunciation

Module Overview

Pronunciation is one of the four IELTS speaking assessment criteria. It refers to how clearly and effectively a candidate can produce spoken English that is easy to understand. IELTS examiners do not penalize candidates for having a foreign accent; they assess whether pronunciation allows clear, intelligible communication.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

61. Explain how pronunciation is assessed in the IELTS Speaking test.
62. Identify common pronunciation difficulties among students.
63. Teach key pronunciation features such as stress, rhythm, and intonation.
64. Use classroom activities that improve pronunciation naturally.
65. Provide effective pronunciation feedback during speaking lessons.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Pronunciation Features Assessed

Feature	Description	Example
Individual Sounds	Correct production of consonants and vowels	Distinguishing /r/ and /l/ sounds
Word Stress	Emphasizing the correct syllable in a word	PHOtograph (not phoTOgraph)
Sentence Stress	Highlighting important words in a sentence	"I REALLY enjoy TRAVELING to DIFFERENT countries."
Intonation	The rise and fall of pitch in speech	Rising pitch for questions; falling for statements
Rhythm	The natural timing and flow of speech	Stressed syllables at regular intervals

Common Pronunciation Problems

Problem	Example	Focus Area
Mispronounced consonants	"rice" pronounced as "lice"	Individual sound production
Incorrect word stress	phoTOgraph vs PHOtograph	Syllable stress patterns
Flat intonation	Monotone speech without pitch variation	Intonation and sentence stress
Unclear sentence stress	Stressing every word equally	Rhythm and natural emphasis

Teachers should focus on improving intelligibility rather than eliminating accents. Prioritize sounds that cause misunderstanding, stress patterns that affect meaning, and rhythm and sentence flow.

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Word Stress Practice

Teacher introduces topic-related words and students identify the stressed syllable: techNOlogy, enVIronment, eduCAtion. Students then use these words in speaking responses.

Activity 2 — Sentence Stress Awareness

Teacher writes a sentence: "I really enjoy traveling to different countries." Students identify the stressed words (really, enjoy, traveling, different, countries) and practice saying it naturally.

Activity 3 — Intonation Practice

Students practice rising intonation for questions ("Do you enjoy traveling?") and falling intonation for statements ("I enjoy traveling to different countries.").

Activity 4 — Shadowing

Students listen to a short model answer and repeat it simultaneously or immediately after. This technique develops rhythm, stress patterns, and natural pronunciation. Shadowing is widely used in pronunciation training.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Focusing excessively on individual sounds at the expense of rhythm and stress.
- Trying to eliminate students' accents.
- Interrupting students frequently during speaking to correct sounds.
- Ignoring pronunciation entirely during speaking practice.

TEACHING TIPS

- Focus on pronunciation features that affect intelligibility most.
- Practice stress and rhythm rather than isolated sounds.
- Encourage students to listen to and imitate natural speech.
- Provide pronunciation feedback after speaking activities, not during.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is intelligibility more important than accent in IELTS speaking?
- What pronunciation features influence communication most?
- How can teachers integrate pronunciation practice into speaking lessons?
- Which classroom activities can improve pronunciation naturally?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What does pronunciation assessment focus on in IELTS speaking?
- What are the key pronunciation features examiners evaluate?
- Why should teachers prioritize intelligibility over accent?
- How can shadowing help students improve pronunciation?

MODULE 14

Correcting Student Speaking Errors

Module Overview

Error correction is an important part of teaching speaking, but it requires careful balance. If teachers interrupt students too frequently, it can reduce fluency, increase anxiety, and discourage students from speaking. Ignoring errors entirely may allow incorrect language patterns to become permanent. Effective teachers learn when and how to correct errors in ways that support both communication and language development.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

66. Identify different types of speaking errors.
67. Decide when error correction is necessary.
68. Apply different corrective feedback techniques.
69. Provide feedback without interrupting fluency practice.
70. Encourage students to self-correct their mistakes.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Types of Speaking Errors

Error Type	Example	Priority for Correction
Grammar	"She go to school every day."	Medium (if communication is clear)
Vocabulary	"This thing is very interesting."	High (affects precision and score)
Pronunciation	Mispronouncing key words	High (if affecting intelligibility)
Word Form	"He is success in business."	High (meaning may be unclear)

Errors that cause misunderstanding should receive higher priority for correction.

When to Correct Errors

Activity Type	Correction Timing	Rationale
Fluency Practice	After the activity	Interrupting reduces speaking flow and confidence
Accuracy Practice	During or immediately after	Accuracy is the primary goal of this activity type

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Corrective Feedback Techniques

Technique	Description	Example
Recasting	Teacher repeats the sentence with correct grammar	Student: "She go to school." Teacher: "Yes, she goes to school every day."
Elicitation	Teacher prompts the student to self-correct	Teacher: "She go... or she...?" Student: "She goes."
Clarification Request	Teacher signals that something is unclear	Teacher: "Sorry, could you say that again?" Student repairs the sentence.
Metalinguistic Feedback	Teacher gives a hint about the error type	Teacher: "Past tense?" Student: "He went yesterday."

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Delayed Feedback Board

During speaking activities, the teacher writes common errors on the board without identifying which student said them. Students work together to correct the sentences. Example: "She go to school every day" → students identify and correct collaboratively.

Activity 2 — Self-Correction Practice

Teacher asks students to listen to their own recorded responses and identify errors in grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation. This builds self-monitoring skills.

Activity 3 — Peer Feedback

Students listen to their partner's speaking response and provide feedback on clarity, vocabulary use, and grammatical accuracy. Peer feedback encourages greater language awareness.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Interrupting students too frequently.
- Correcting every small error, including those that do not affect meaning.
- Embarrassing students during correction in front of the class.
- Providing corrections without explaining how to improve.

TEACHING TIPS

- Prioritize errors that affect communication.
- Use delayed correction during fluency activities.
- Encourage students to self-correct when possible.
- Use supportive and constructive feedback at all times.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why can excessive correction reduce speaking fluency?
- What types of errors should teachers prioritize?
- How can teachers encourage self-correction?
- What are the advantages of delayed feedback?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What are common types of speaking errors?
- When should teachers correct errors during fluency practice?
- What is recasting?
- Why is delayed feedback effective in speaking lessons?

MODULE 15

Designing Effective IELTS Speaking Lessons

Module Overview

Effective IELTS speaking instruction requires a balance between language input, idea development, speaking practice, and feedback. A well-designed speaking lesson guides students through several stages that prepare them to produce clear, confident responses. This module introduces a structured lesson framework that teachers can use to design effective IELTS speaking classes.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

71. Structure an effective IELTS speaking lesson.
72. Balance input, idea generation, and speaking practice.
73. Design lessons that develop fluency and accuracy.
74. Integrate IELTS-style speaking questions into classroom activities.
75. Provide meaningful feedback after speaking practice.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Common Challenges in Speaking Classes

Problem	Description	Solution
Too Much Output	Students are asked to speak immediately without preparation	Begin with input and idea development
Idea Shortage	Students do not know what to say	Provide content input and brainstorming activities
Over-Correction	Teachers interrupt students too frequently	Use delayed feedback; correct after speaking
Low Participation	Only a few students speak actively	Use pair and group work to increase speaking time

The 45-Minute IELTS Speaking Lesson Model

Stage	Time	Purpose	Example Activity
Warm-Up	5 min	Introduce topic; activate background knowledge	"What technology do you use every day?"
Input	10 min	Provide vocabulary and ideas related to the topic	Short reading + vocabulary introduction
Idea Development	10 min	Brainstorm and discuss; generate content	Pair discussion: advantages/disadvantages
Speaking Practice	15 min	IELTS-style questions from Parts 1, 2, and 3	Timed responses; cue card simulation
Feedback	5 min	Error correction; vocabulary review; reflection	Delayed feedback board; self-assessment

Integrating All Three Speaking Parts in One Lesson

Using one topic across all three parts helps students see the progression and practice different skills in a single lesson.

Part	Example Question (Topic: Travel)
Part 1	"Do you enjoy traveling?"
Part 2	"Describe a memorable trip you took."
Part 3	"How has tourism changed in recent years?"

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Sample Lesson Outline — Topic: Technology

Stage	Activity	Time
Warm-Up	Students discuss: "What technology do you use every day?"	5 min
Input	Introduce vocabulary: digital communication, AI, online platforms. Students read a short statement about technology.	10 min
Idea Development	Students discuss advantages and disadvantages of technology in pairs.	10 min
Speaking Practice	Part 1: "What technology do you use most?" Part 3: "How might technology change communication in the future?"	15 min
Feedback	Review vocabulary usage, grammar errors, and pronunciation issues from the session.	5 min

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Skipping the input stage and asking students to speak immediately.
- Allowing a few students to dominate the conversation.
- Providing little or no feedback after speaking tasks.
- Failing to connect the lesson activities to IELTS scoring criteria.

TEACHING TIPS

- Provide topic input before speaking activities.
- Encourage pair or group discussion to increase participation.
- Use timed speaking tasks to improve fluency.
- Provide constructive feedback at the end of the lesson.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is input important before speaking practice?
- How does idea development support speaking fluency?
- Why should speaking lessons include feedback?
- How can teachers encourage participation from all students?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What does IDEA stand for in the lesson framework?
- Why is the input stage important?
- How long should speaking practice typically last in a 45-minute lesson?
- Why is feedback necessary after speaking tasks?

MODULE 16

Teaching Students What to Do When They Do Not Understand the Question

Module Overview

In the IELTS Speaking test, candidates sometimes encounter questions they do not fully understand or find difficult to interpret quickly. When this happens, many students panic, remain silent, or produce very short answers. Teachers must train students to analyze the question, identify the key idea, and respond confidently — even when the topic feels unfamiliar.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

76. Identify why students fail to understand IELTS speaking questions.
77. Teach students how to identify key words in questions.
78. Train students to paraphrase questions mentally.
79. Help students respond to unfamiliar topics.
80. Use classroom activities that develop question interpretation skills.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Why Students Do Not Understand Questions

Cause	Description	Teaching Response
Vocabulary Gap	Student does not know a word in the question	Teach keyword identification skills
Unfamiliar Topic	Student has never considered the topic before	Build content knowledge through input
Complex Structure	Question grammar is confusing	Teach question type recognition
Exam Anxiety	Student panics and stops thinking clearly	Repeated exposure to varied questions

Recognizing Common Question Types

Question Type	Signal Words	Example
Opinion	"Do you think...?", "Do you believe...?"	"Do you think technology has improved communication?"
Reason	"Why do...?", "What causes...?"	"Why do people enjoy traveling?"
Comparison	"How is X different from Y?", "Compare..."	"How is education different today compared to the past?"
Prediction	"How might...?", "What will...?"	"How might technology change education in the future?"
Advantage/Disadvantage	"What are the benefits/drawbacks of...?"	"What are the advantages of living in a big city?"

The Question Breakdown Technique

Step	Action	Example (question: "Why do people enjoy traveling?")
Step 1	Identify the topic	Topic → traveling
Step 2	Identify the task (question type)	Task → explain reason
Step 3	Think of one example	Example → relaxation, exploration
Step 4	Start speaking	Begin with "Well, I think one reason is..."

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Question Analysis

Teacher presents several IELTS speaking questions. Students identify the topic, question type, and key words. Example: "Why do many people prefer living in cities?" → Topic: city life; Task: explain reason.

Activity 2 — Question Paraphrasing

Students practice paraphrasing questions in their own words. Example: "What are the advantages of traveling abroad?" → "Why is traveling to other countries beneficial?" This improves comprehension and flexibility.

Activity 3 — Rapid Response Training

Teacher asks unfamiliar questions. Students must respond within 5 seconds using the Question Breakdown Technique. Example questions: "Why do people enjoy museums?", "How might education change in the future?", "What makes a good teacher?"

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Explaining questions too quickly, preventing students from developing interpretation skills.
- Translating questions directly into the student's native language.
- Allowing students to skip or avoid unfamiliar questions.
- Over-simplifying speaking prompts rather than building handling strategies.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage students to focus on the main idea of the question.
- Teach students to recognize common question types.
- Practice paraphrasing questions regularly.
- Train students to start speaking even if their ideas are not perfect.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why do students sometimes fail to respond to speaking questions?
- How can teachers train students to identify the main idea of a question?
- Why is paraphrasing helpful when interpreting questions?
- How can teachers help students respond to unfamiliar topics?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What are common reasons students misunderstand speaking questions?
- What two elements should students identify in a question?
- Why is mental paraphrasing useful?
- What classroom activities can help students interpret questions more effectively?

MODULE 17

Teaching Students How to Buy Thinking Time

Module Overview

During the IELTS Speaking test, candidates sometimes encounter questions that require a moment of thought — especially for unfamiliar topics, abstract Part 3 questions, or complex opinion questions. If students pause silently for too long, examiners may interpret this as difficulty maintaining fluency. Teachers should train students to buy thinking time naturally, using conversational expressions that maintain the flow of communication.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

81. Explain why students sometimes need thinking time during speaking.
82. Teach natural hesitation strategies that maintain fluency.
83. Help students avoid long silent pauses.
84. Train students to organize ideas while speaking.
85. Use classroom activities that build spontaneous speaking skills.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Silent Pauses vs Natural Hesitation

Type	Example	Effect on Fluency Score
Silent Pause	Long silence; student stops speaking entirely	Negative — reduces fluency score
Natural Hesitation	"That's an interesting question. Let me think about that..."	Neutral to positive — maintains communication flow

Common Thinking-Time Expressions

Expression	When to Use
"That's an interesting question."	When the question is unexpected or complex
"Let me think about that for a moment."	When ideas take time to form
"I've never really thought about that before."	When the topic is unfamiliar
"Well, in my opinion..."	When beginning to state a position
"That's a good point. I think..."	When responding to examiner follow-up

Appropriate Use of Fillers

Fillers such as "Well...", "Actually...", and "You know..." are natural speech features that allow speakers to maintain conversational flow. However, excessive use of fillers may reduce clarity. Teachers should encourage students to use fillers sparingly and naturally — not as a scripted habit.

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Using Structured Thinking Patterns

Students can combine thinking-time phrases with simple response structures. Example: Question: "Why do people prefer living in big cities?" → Response: "That's an interesting question. I think one of the main reasons is that cities provide more job opportunities." The thinking-time phrase buys seconds to organize an answer.

IDEA Framework with Thinking-Time Expressions

Stage	Application
Input	The question is received
Develop Ideas	Use a thinking-time phrase while organizing thoughts
Express	Deliver the answer
Advance	Add an example or explanation

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Thinking-Time Practice

Teacher asks difficult questions. Students must begin their answers using a thinking-time phrase. Example: "How might education change in the future?" → "That's an interesting question. I think education might become more technology-based."

Activity 2 — No Silence Rule

During speaking practice, students must avoid silent pauses longer than two seconds. If they stop speaking, they must use a thinking-time phrase to continue. This encourages continuous speech.

Activity 3 — Question Rotation with Unfamiliar Topics

Students practice answering multiple unfamiliar questions (e.g., "Why do people enjoy art?", "What makes a good leader?") using hesitation strategies and the Question Breakdown Technique from Module 16.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Discouraging all hesitation expressions as signs of weakness.
- Expecting immediate answers to all questions.
- Treating pauses as errors that must be corrected.
- Not teaching strategies for managing thinking time.

TEACHING TIPS

- Teach several simple thinking-time phrases.
- Encourage students to avoid long silent pauses.
- Practice responding to unfamiliar questions regularly.
- Emphasize natural communication rather than memorized phrases.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why do students sometimes need thinking time during speaking?
- What is the difference between silent pauses and natural hesitation?
- How can teachers train students to manage pauses effectively?
- Why should hesitation expressions sound natural rather than memorized?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- Why is silent hesitation problematic in speaking tests?
- What are examples of thinking-time expressions?
- How can teachers train students to avoid long pauses?
- Why should hesitation strategies sound natural?

MODULE 18

IELTS Speaking Classroom Activities

Module Overview

Speaking ability improves primarily through active use of language. Effective IELTS speaking lessons should include a variety of interactive activities that encourage students to speak more frequently, organize ideas quickly, expand their responses, and interact with other speakers. This module introduces several classroom activities designed specifically for IELTS speaking preparation.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

86. Use a variety of classroom speaking activities.
87. Increase student participation in speaking lessons.
88. Develop fluency through structured practice tasks.
89. Encourage students to expand their answers.
90. Prepare students for different parts of the IELTS speaking test.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Activity Types and Their Purposes

Activity Type	Purpose	Best IELTS Section
Fluency Drills	Increase speaking speed and natural flow	All parts
Discussion Tasks	Develop reasoning and explanation skills	Parts 1 and 3
Debates	Practice argumentation and position-taking	Part 3
Timed Speaking	Simulate exam conditions; build stamina	Part 2
Role-Play (Examiner–Candidate)	Encourage interactive communication	All parts
Cue Card Simulation	Practice Part 2 format and structure	Part 2
Rapid Question Drills	Improve response speed	Part 1

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Rapid Question Drill

Purpose: Improve fluency and spontaneous speaking. Teacher asks a series of short Part 1-style questions. Students must respond immediately with 2–3 sentences. Example questions: "Do you enjoy traveling?", "What do you usually do on weekends?", "Do you prefer coffee or tea?"

Activity 2 — Timed Speaking

Purpose: Develop extended speaking ability. Students answer a question for increasing time increments (30 seconds → 60 seconds → 90 seconds). This helps students sustain speech for longer periods and reduces the panic of Part 2 tasks.

Activity 3 — Cue Card Simulation

Purpose: Practice Part 2 speaking tasks. Teacher gives students cue cards similar to those used in the IELTS exam. Students have 1 minute to prepare and 2 minutes to speak.

Sample cue card:

> *Describe a place you enjoy visiting. You should say: where it is • what you do there • who you go with*

Activity 4 — Opinion Debate

Purpose: Practice Part 3 discussion skills. Teacher presents a statement (e.g., "Social media improves communication"). Students form two groups (agree / disagree) and present arguments and examples. This develops reasoning skills and vocabulary for argumentation.

Activity 5 — Idea Expansion

Purpose: Encourage longer, more developed answers. Teacher asks a question. Students must include one reason, one example, and one explanation. This helps students produce more detailed responses aligned with IELTS scoring expectations.

Activity 6 — Partner Interview

Purpose: Develop interactive speaking. Students interview each other using IELTS-style questions (e.g., "What hobbies do you enjoy?", "What is your favorite place to visit?"). Students then report their partner's answers to the class.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Dominating speaking time with explanations instead of student practice.
- Asking questions without clear objectives.
- Allowing only a few students to speak, leaving others passive.
- Repeating the same activity in every class, reducing engagement.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage pair and group speaking activities to maximize talk time.
- Use timed speaking tasks to simulate exam conditions.
- Rotate activities to maintain student engagement.
- Provide feedback after speaking practice.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is variety important in speaking classes?
- How can teachers increase student speaking time?
- Which activities help develop extended speaking ability?
- How can teachers simulate IELTS speaking conditions?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What are examples of fluency-building activities?
- Which activity helps students practice Part 2 speaking tasks?
- Why are timed speaking activities useful?
- How can debates support Part 3 speaking skills?

MODULE 19

Running Effective IELTS Speaking Practice Tests

Module Overview

Practice speaking tests are an essential part of IELTS preparation. They allow students to experience real exam conditions, develop confidence during the interview, and receive feedback on their speaking performance. For practice tests to be effective, teachers must conduct them in a way that closely replicates the real IELTS speaking test.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

91. Conduct a realistic IELTS speaking interview.
92. Follow the correct structure for each speaking section.
93. Manage timing during the test.
94. Evaluate student performance using band descriptors.
95. Provide constructive feedback after the test.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Structure of the IELTS Speaking Test

Section	Duration	Purpose
Part 1	4–5 minutes	Introduction and personal questions
Part 2	3–4 minutes	Long turn (cue card task)
Part 3	4–5 minutes	Abstract discussion
Total	11–14 minutes	Complete speaking assessment

Examiner Behavior Guidelines

During the real IELTS speaking test, examiners follow strict guidelines. Teachers should adopt similar behavior when conducting mock tests to help students experience authentic exam conditions.

Examiner Behavior	Teacher Application
Ask questions clearly	Read questions naturally without over-explaining
Avoid unnecessary explanations	Do not define vocabulary or simplify prompts
Maintain a neutral tone	Neither overly encouraging nor cold; stay professional
Do not interrupt excessively	Allow students to complete their responses

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Step-by-Step Mock Test Procedure

Step	Action	Purpose
Introduction	Greet the student: "Good afternoon. My name is [Name]. I will be your examiner today." Ask name and location.	Help students feel comfortable; replicate the exam opening
Part 1	Ask questions about 2–3 familiar topics (hometown, hobbies, daily life). Allow 4–5 minutes.	Assess conversational ability; build student confidence
Part 2	Give cue card and paper. Say: "You have one minute to prepare." After 1 minute, student speaks for 1–2 minutes.	Assess extended speaking ability and organization
Part 3	Ask 3–5 connected questions expanding on the Part 2 topic. Allow 4–5 minutes.	Assess reasoning, argumentation, and abstract thinking

Providing Feedback After the Test

Feedback should focus on all four speaking criteria. Teachers should highlight strengths, identify areas for improvement, and suggest specific strategies.

Criterion	Feedback Focus
Fluency and Coherence	Smoothness, pauses, logical organization
Lexical Resource	Vocabulary range, paraphrasing, repetition
Grammatical Range and Accuracy	Sentence variety, common errors
Pronunciation	Stress patterns, rhythm, intelligibility

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Full Mock Test

One student acts as the candidate; the teacher acts as the examiner. Other students observe and take notes. After the test, the teacher provides feedback using the band descriptors.

Activity 2 — Peer Examiner Practice

Students work in pairs. One plays the examiner role; the other is the candidate. The examiner follows the official test structure. This helps students understand how the interview works from both sides.

Activity 3 — Band Score Evaluation

Teacher plays a recorded speaking response or conducts a mock test. Students attempt to evaluate the performance using IELTS band descriptors. Students compare their scores with the teacher's evaluation and discuss any differences.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Interrupting students frequently during mock tests.
- Correcting errors during the test instead of after.
- Asking additional questions beyond the standard test format.
- Allowing the test to run much longer than 14 minutes.

TEACHING TIPS

- Use a timer to control test duration precisely.
- Maintain neutral examiner behavior throughout the test.
- Avoid giving feedback until the full test is finished.
- Use official band descriptors when evaluating performance.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is it important to replicate real exam conditions during mock tests?
- What is the purpose of each section of the speaking test?
- How can teachers provide effective feedback after speaking tests?
- Why should teachers avoid interrupting students during the interview?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- How long does the IELTS speaking test usually last?
- What are the three sections of the speaking test?
- How much preparation time is given in Part 2?
- Why is accurate timing important during mock tests?

MODULE 20

Using Feedback and Self-Assessment to Improve Speaking

Module Overview

Feedback plays a crucial role in language learning. In IELTS speaking preparation, feedback helps students understand their strengths, identify areas for improvement, and develop specific strategies for progress. However, teacher feedback alone is not always sufficient. Students also need to develop the ability to evaluate their own speaking performance — a skill that promotes independent learning and long-term improvement.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

96. Provide constructive feedback on speaking performance.
97. Teach students how to evaluate their own speaking skills.
98. Incorporate peer feedback into speaking activities.
99. Use reflection techniques to support improvement.
100. Encourage students to take responsibility for their speaking development.

CORE KNOWLEDGE

Types of Feedback

Type	Description	Advantage
Teacher Feedback	Instructor evaluates speaking performance	Expert, accurate assessment aligned to band descriptors
Peer Feedback	Students evaluate each other's responses	Encourages active listening; builds evaluation skills
Self-Assessment	Students evaluate their own speaking	Promotes independent learning and self-monitoring

Effective feedback should focus on improvement, be specific and constructive, and encourage student reflection. General comments such as "Good job" or "Try harder" are less helpful than detailed, criteria-linked feedback.

Benefits of Self-Assessment

Students who regularly evaluate their own speaking can identify recurring mistakes, monitor their progress, and set personal improvement goals. Self-assessment also helps students better understand the IELTS band descriptors, making them more strategic learners.

TEACHING METHODOLOGY

Using Speaking Checklists

Provide students with a self-evaluation checklist after speaking tasks:

Self-Evaluation Question	Criterion Addressed
Did I speak for the full time without long pauses?	Fluency and Coherence
Did I explain my ideas clearly and logically?	Fluency and Coherence
Did I give examples to support my points?	Fluency and Coherence
Did I use varied vocabulary?	Lexical Resource
Did I avoid repeating the same words?	Lexical Resource
Did I use a variety of sentence structures?	Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Was my speech clear and easy to understand?	Pronunciation

Recording and Reviewing Speaking Responses

Students can record their speaking practice using mobile phones or computers. After recording, students listen to their responses and evaluate pronunciation, grammar, fluency, and vocabulary. This method allows students to hear their own speaking performance objectively — something that is very difficult to do in real time.

Goal-Setting

Teachers can help students set specific improvement goals. Examples: "Speak more fluently during Part 2 tasks by using the storytelling structure", "Use more varied vocabulary by paraphrasing at least once per answer", "Reduce grammatical errors by focusing on verb tense accuracy."

CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Activity 1 — Self-Evaluation Checklist

After completing a speaking task, students complete the self-evaluation checklist above. Students reflect on their performance before receiving teacher feedback, which makes the teacher's comments more meaningful.

Activity 2 — Peer Feedback Exchange

Students listen to their partner's speaking response and provide feedback on clarity, vocabulary, and fluency. Structured peer feedback forms can guide students toward specific, useful observations.

Activity 3 — Speaking Reflection Journal

Students keep a record of their speaking practice. After each speaking activity, students write: (1) What I did well, (2) What I need to improve, (3) What strategies I will use next time. This builds long-term awareness and supports continuous improvement.

COMMON TEACHER MISTAKES

- Providing only general feedback ("Good job!") without specifics.
- Focusing only on grammar errors and neglecting other criteria.
- Neglecting student reflection activities.
- Correcting errors without explaining how to improve.

TEACHING TIPS

- Encourage students to reflect on their speaking performance after every task.
- Use checklists to guide self-evaluation.
- Incorporate peer feedback activities regularly.
- Help students set clear, specific, and achievable learning goals.

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- Why is feedback important in speaking development?
- How can self-assessment improve student learning?
- What are the advantages of peer feedback?
- How can teachers help students reflect on their speaking performance?

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

- What are three types of feedback in speaking classes?
- Why is self-assessment useful for IELTS preparation?
- How can students evaluate their own speaking performance?
- Why should feedback focus on improvement rather than criticism?

End of Teacher's Handbook

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